Akanksha Sharma

Data Analytics Specialist — Institutional Research & Planning

POWER BI · SQL · PYTHON · TABLEAU

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data analytics professional with 7+ years turning data into decisions across fintech, automotive data, government IT, consulting, and higher-education institutional research. Currently Data Analytics Specialist in the University of North Carolina Wilmington's Office of Institutional Research & Planning — building institutional reports and dashboards, strengthening data quality, and partnering with campus stakeholders. Doctor of Information Technology (DIT) doctoral student at Trine University (4.00 GPA).

EXPERIENCE

Data Analytics Specialist — May 2026 – Present

University of North Carolina Wilmington · Full-time · Wilmington, NC (On-site) · IRP Team Profile

Support data-informed decision-making across the university by building and maintaining institutional reports and dashboards. Ensure data quality and consistency across analytical outputs. Partner with campus stakeholders to clarify reporting requirements and communicate findings in accessible language. Apply SQL, Python, Tableau, Azure Databricks, and statistical analysis to institutional analytics use cases.

Consultant — Aug 2024 – Jun 2025

Source Mantra · Full-time · Remote

Delivered client-focused data and analytics support using Python and SQL for reporting, analysis, and business problem-solving. Performed statistical analysis to identify patterns and translate results into stakeholder-ready insights. Partnered with remote stakeholders to align deliverables to requirements.

Intern — Sep 2023 – Aug 2024

MOTOR Information Systems · Internship · Hybrid (Troy, MI)

Completed a year-long hybrid internship supporting data initiatives in the automotive information space. Assisted with data organization, validation, and reporting support. Built automotive data context that informed subsequent Power BI dashboard development.

Backend Data Specialist — Jun 2020 – Nov 2022

CredAble · Full-time · Remote (Mumbai Metropolitan Region, India)

Managed backend data operations for a fintech company with emphasis on dependable data processing, organization, and accuracy. Supported database work, data maintenance, and issue resolution. Collaborated cross-functionally to improve data usability for business reporting.

Technical Data Associate — Jan 2016 – Dec 2018

Fast Enterprises, LLC · Full-time · On-site (Atlanta, GA)

Supported government IT implementations with data conversion, validation, and reporting. Provided technical data support, issue resolution, and operational delivery with attention to data integrity and stakeholder service.

Engineering Co-op — Aug 2012 – Aug 2015

Technicolor

Completed 4 of 5 co-op terms through Purdue's co-op program (Fall 2012, Summer 2013, Summer 2014, Summer 2015).

Campus Ambassador — Aug 2014 – May 2015

McGraw Hill · Purdue University

Student Ambassador promoting McGraw Hill learning products and resources on campus.

SPEAKING

Guest Lecturer — "Data Visualization (Session 1)" — Oct 14, 2026

EDL 586/686 Program Evaluation, Watson College of Education, UNCW

Delivered a mini-lecture plus a hands-on "Bad Data Clinic" activity via Zoom; invited by Dr. Satlaj Dighe.

PROJECTS

Student Success Benchmark github.com/sharmauncw/student-success-benchmark — *Power BI · DAX · Python · Streamlit*
Peer-benchmarked student-success analytics on synthetic data: a star-schema model with DAX measures and an interactive Streamlit/Plotly demo. Headline findings: 84.3% first-year retention, four-year graduation +8.0 points vs. benchmark, $8,553 average graduate debt, and a 4.5-point Pell retention gap flagged for follow-up.

Streaming Content Analytics github.com/sharmauncw/streaming-content-analytics — *Python · scikit-learn · DuckDB · SQL*
End-to-end analysis of the MovieLens catalog and ratings: pandas EDA, k-means catalog segmentation, a content-based recommender, and analytical SQL in DuckDB.

Retail Sales Forecasting github.com/sharmauncw/retail-sales-forecasting — *Python · Holt-Winters · DuckDB*
Ninety-day sales forecast with confidence bands on synthetic retail data: Holt-Winters exponential smoothing, residual-based anomaly detection, and a DuckDB analytics mart for month-over-month store and category performance.

Automotive Repair Data Dashboard — *Power BI · SQL Server · SQL*
Interactive dashboard analyzing 500,000+ automotive repair records. Reusable Power Query transformations; DAX measures for KPIs, trends, and time intelligence; fact/dimension semantic models; scheduled refresh and row-level security; drill-through, tooltip, and bookmark self-service experiences.

Bad Chart Clinic github.com/sharmauncw/bad-chart-clinic — *Python · Matplotlib*
Six pairs of misleading vs. corrected data visualizations with numerically honest fixes — a teaching clinic for honest chart design.

Talking Resume Pipeline github.com/sharmauncw/talking-resume-pipeline — *Python*
Automated pipeline that turns a resume into a narrated video: scripted narration, TTS voiceover, subtitles, and assembled video.

Enrollment What-If Simulator github.com/sharmauncw/enrollment-whatif-simulator — *Python · Streamlit*
Scenario-modeling tool for enrollment planning — adjust policy levers and project outcomes forward; no fitted models, no leakage.

WiFi Indoor Navigation System — *Purdue ECE senior capstone (Spring 2015)*
Indoor positioning system using WiFi signal data; built by a team of 4 including Sidharth Mudgal.

Banner-Style Datamart SQL Patterns github.com/sharmauncw/banner-datamart-sql-patterns — *SQL*
Sanitized SQL reporting patterns for higher-ed datamarts — cohort definitions, retention, DFW rates, course-outcome analysis.

EDUCATION

Doctor of Information Technology, Trine University **Jun 2025 – Dec 2030 (expected)**
GPA 4.00. Coursework: Data Science & Big Data; Cybersecurity; Computer Science with Python (A); Network Management (A); Graduate Internship.

Master's Degree, Management Information Systems, Oakland University **Jan 2023 – Jun 2024**
GPA 3.30.

B.S., Computer Engineering, Purdue University **Aug 2011 – Dec 2015**
GPA 3.23. Dean's List; Society of Women Engineers award; Technicolor co-op (4 terms); full Stanford summer-school scholarship.

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner — Jan 2024 – Jan 2027

Post Graduate Program in Data Science and Business Analytics, Texas McCombs School of Business — Sep 2022

Professional coursework (Google): Grow as a Manager; Support Individual Growth and Development; Create a High-Performing Team; Set and Achieve Team Goals — Jan 2026

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

PMP Exam Prep (coursework), uCertify — Jul 2025

SKILLS

BI & Visualization: Power BI (DAX, Power Query, semantic modeling, row-level security), Tableau

Data: SQL, SQL Server (SSMS), Python, Jupyter, statistical analysis, data modeling, data quality & validation, Azure Databricks, AWS

Professional: Prompt engineering, project management, stakeholder collaboration, institutional research & planning